

The Noble Perfection of Wisdom of the Blessed Lady in Fifty Lines

Āryabhagavatīprajñāpāramitāpañcāśatikā · Toh 18 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་བཅོམ་ལྷན་འདས་མ་ཤེས་རབ་གཏི་ལྷན་ལྷན་པ་ལྷན་པ་ལྷན་པ་

The Noble Perfection of Wisdom of the Blessed Lady in Fifty Lines, known in Sanskrit as the Āryabhagavatī-prajñāpāramitā-pañcāśatikā and in Tibetan as Phags pa bcom ldan 'das ma shes rab kyi pha rol tu phyin pa lnga bcu pa, is a short Prajñāpāramitā sūtra belonging to the Perfection of Wisdom class of Mahāyāna scriptures. As its title indicates, the text is a condensed teaching on the perfection of wisdom, delivered by the Buddha at Vulture Peak Mountain in Rājagṛha to an assembly of monks, bodhisattvas, and various divine and worldly beings, with the venerable Subhūti as the primary interlocutor. The discourse addresses those wishing to train at the levels of śrāvaka, pratyekabuddha, and bodhisattva, offering a succinct distillation of prajñāpāramitā doctrine. It is catalogued as Toh 18 in the Kangyur, where it forms part of the collection of Perfection of Wisdom sūtras.

The tenth chapter is complete.

In the language of India: Āryabhagavatī-prajñāpāramitā-pañcāśatikā.

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Perfection of Wisdom of the Blessed Lady in Fifty Lines.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha on Vulture Peak Mountain together with a great Saṅgha of monks and a great Saṅgha of bodhisattvas, and also together with Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), Brahmā, the world-guardians, gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and great serpents, as well as monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen in great numbers.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Subhūti: Subhūti, whoever wishes to train in the level of a śrāvaka, or whoever wishes to train in the level of a pratyekabuddha, should listen to, take up, retain, recite, and fully penetrate this very Perfection of Wisdom. A bodhisattva endowed with skillful means should devote earnest effort to this very Perfection of Wisdom in order to perfectly accomplish all the qualities of buddhas and bodhisattvas. Why is that? Because, Subhūti, all the qualities of buddhas and bodhisattvas that a

bodhisattva, a great being, is to train in and to practice have been extensively taught within this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Whoever wishes to train in unsurpassed perfect and complete awakening should also listen to, take up, retain, recite, and fully penetrate this very Perfection of Wisdom. A bodhisattva endowed with skillful means should devote earnest effort to this very Perfection of Wisdom in order to perfectly accomplish all the qualities of buddhas and bodhisattvas. Why is that? Because, Subhūti, all the qualities of buddhas and bodhisattvas that a bodhisattva, a great being, is to train in and to practice have been extensively taught within this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti, all wholesome qualities on the side of awakening, the qualities of śrāvakas, the qualities of pratyekabuddhas, the qualities of bodhisattvas, and the qualities of buddhas — all of these are contained within, gathered into, absorbed by, and perfectly converge upon the Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti then asked: Blessed One, it is said that whoever wishes to train in the level of a śrāvaka, or whoever wishes to train in the level of a pratyekabuddha, should train in and practice this very Perfection of Wisdom, and should listen to, take up, retain, recite, and fully penetrate it along with the qualities of buddhas and the qualities of bodhisattvas — and that all wholesome qualities on the side of awakening, the qualities of śrāvakas, the qualities of pratyekabuddhas, the qualities of bodhisattvas, and the qualities of buddhas are contained within, gathered into, absorbed by, and perfectly converge upon the Perfection of Wisdom. What exactly are these?

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, these are as follows: the perfection of generosity, the perfection of moral discipline, the perfection of patience, the perfection of diligence, the perfection of meditative concentration, the perfection of wisdom, inner emptiness, outer emptiness, inner and outer emptiness,

the emptiness of emptiness, great emptiness, ultimate emptiness, the emptiness of the conditioned, the emptiness of the unconditioned, the emptiness that transcends all extremes, the emptiness of that which has no beginning and no end, the emptiness of that which is not to be cast aside, emptiness of intrinsic nature, the emptiness of all phenomena, the emptiness of defining characteristics, emptiness of the unapprehendable, the emptiness of non-existence, the emptiness of essential nature, the emptiness of the essential nature of non-existence, the four applications of mindfulness, the

four genuine restraints, the four bases of miraculous power, the five faculties, the five powers, the seven limbs of awakening, the noble eightfold path, the Four Noble Truths, the four immeasurables, the four absorptions of the formless realm, the eight liberations, the nine successive meditative absorptions, the three gates of liberation — emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness — the direct cognitions, the meditative absorptions, the dhāraṇī gateways, the ten powers of the Tathāgata, the four fearlessnesses, the four analytical knowledges, great loving-kindness, great compassion, the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha, the fruit of stream-entry, the fruit of once-returning, the fruit of non-returning, arhatship, self-awakening, knowledge of all things, knowledge of the aspects of the path, and omniscience. Subhūti, these are the virtuous qualities on the side of awakening, the qualities of śrāvakas, the qualities of pratyekabuddhas, the qualities of bodhisattvas, and the qualities of buddhas — all of them are contained within, gathered into, absorbed by, and perfectly converge upon the Perfection of Wisdom.

Subhūti then asked: Blessed One, that all these virtuous qualities on the side of awakening, the qualities of śrāvakas, the qualities of pratyekabuddhas, the qualities of bodhisattvas, and the qualities of buddhas are contained within, gathered into, absorbed by, and perfectly converge upon the Perfection of Wisdom — Blessed One, how wonderful, how truly wonderful! This Perfection of Wisdom is indeed profound.

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, it is so because the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly secluded.

Subhūti said: Blessed One, how wonderful, how truly wonderful! This Perfection of Wisdom is difficult to fathom.

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, it is so because the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly pure.

Subhūti said: Blessed One, how wonderful, how wonderful! This Perfection of Wisdom is like space.

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, it is so because the Perfection of Wisdom is utterly pure. And therefore, Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom is like space.

Subhūti said: Blessed One, how wonderful, how wonderful! This Perfection of Wisdom is difficult to realize for one who does not apply themselves to it.

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, that is so, that is so. It is exactly as you have said. The Perfection of Wisdom is difficult to realize for one who does not apply themselves earnestly, who has little wholesome roots, who is faint of heart, who does not seek its meaning, who lacks learning, who is deficient in wisdom,

who is seized by evil companions, who associates frequently with evil companions, who is held in the grip of evil companions, who possesses only a little faith, who is a beginner and conducts themselves as one without good fortune, who is not by nature inclined to inquire thoroughly, whose wisdom has been made to go astray, who is lazy, who has little diligence, who has little courage, who has little aspiration, and who does not strive earnestly toward those virtuous qualities — for such a one it is difficult to take delight in this teaching. Therefore, Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom is said to be difficult to take delight in.

Furthermore, Subhūti, whatever son or daughter of good family listens to this profound Perfection of Wisdom, retains it, holds it, reads it, masters it thoroughly, or expounds it widely and correctly to others — that person has taken hold of the awakening of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past, the future, and the present. Therefore, Subhūti, whatever son or daughter of good family, possessing abundant and excellent aspiration, wishes to swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — they should listen to, retain, hold, read, and thoroughly master the Perfection of Wisdom without interruption. By doing so they will swiftly come to full and perfect awakening in unsurpassed, complete enlightenment.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the venerable Subhūti, those monks, those bodhisattvas, and the world of gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and, with delight, gave

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "absorbed by and perfectly converge upon" translates the Tibetan that literally means something like "falling into and accurately inclined toward" — the two verbs suggest that all these qualities are subsumed within and ultimately oriented toward the Perfection of Wisdom. This is a standard doctrinal point in the *prajñāpāramitā* literature.

The text breaks off mid-sentence with the list of emptinesses, indicating this is a partial passage; the translation preserves that open ending faithfully.

- The exclamations rendered as "how wonderful, how truly wonderful" translate the Tibetan interjections "kyema" and "alala," which are traditional expressions of wonder and admiration. Their doubling and variation in the original is preserved in the translation's phrasing.

- The final sentence breaks off mid-phrase at "gave," corresponding to the Tibetan བསྐྱེད་གསོལ་བཤམས་ which ends the passage abruptly. The full phrase would continue with something like "gave their full and manifest approval to what the Blessed One had taught" — a standard sūtra closing formula — but that portion lies beyond the supplied text and has not been translated.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.